About the Poet



James Falconer Kirkup (1918-2009) born James Harold Kirkup, was an English poet, translator and travelogue writer. He wrote over 30 books, including autobiographies, novels and plays. Kirkup wrote his first book of poetry, The Drowned Sailor at the Downs, which was published in 1947. His home town of South Shields now holds a growing collection of his works in the Central Library, and artefacts from his time in Japan are housed in the nearby Museum. His last volume of poetry was published during the summer of 2008 by Red Squirrel Press, and was launched at a special event at Central Library in South Shields.

Glossary

labour (n) - hardwork
betray (v) - disloyal / reveal something unintentionally or intentionally
condemn (v) - express complete disapproval
defile (v) - damage the purity or appearance
outrage (v) - offend / scandalize

Based on the understanding of the poem, read the following lines and answer the questions given below.

1. *Beneath all uniforms, a single body breathes*
   Like ours: the land our brothers walk upon
   Is earth like this, in which we all shall lie.

   a) What is found beneath all uniforms?
   b) What is same for every one of us?
   c) Where are we all going to lie finally?

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2. *They, too, aware of sun and air and water,*
   Are fed by peaceful harvests, by war's long winter starv'd.

   a) What is common for all of us?
   b) How are we fed?
   c) Mention the season referred here.

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